

Ares Benchmark Report

Ares Benchmark Comparison Report

Inputs used

- Benchmark PDF: hermes-vyapar-agent-spec.PDF
- Raw extraction: docs/ares/benchmark/EXTRACTED_SPEC.md
- Product contract: docs/ares/benchmark/SOURCE_OF_TRUTH.md
- Current build analysis: docs/ares/benchmark/CURRENT_BUILD_GAP_ANALYSIS.md

Headline conclusion

Ares now has a serious pilot foundation, but it is still **far from the final benchmark state** described in the Hermes Vyapar specification.

Best description of current state

- **Yes:** approval-first concierge pilot engine
- **Yes:** operator-ready morning-run workflow
- **Yes:** local persistence and audit trail foundation
- **No:** benchmark-complete wholesale operating system
- **No:** polished self-serve SaaS
- **No:** production integration-complete compliance/business stack

What the benchmark demands

The benchmark defines:

- **9 modules**
- **47 features claimed in the PDF footer**
- **48 explicitly enumerated feature rows in the module tables**
- **3 build phases**
- final polish gates around compliance, owner trust, low-friction UX, Tally compatibility, and full udhaar control

What the current build already proves

- Deterministic client setup and local state
- Operator workflow around dropped exports/messages
- Morning-run orchestration

- Approval-first owner loop
- Persistent repository and audit-style execution logging

Biggest product gaps

- GST/compliance engine
- Real WhatsApp business layer
- Inventory depth (batch/expiry/GRN)
- Principal / beat / claims intelligence
- Financial ops and bank reconciliation depth
- Analytics and owner financial intelligence
- Real external integrations (Tally, GSTN, gateways, logistics)
- Hosted product shell for SaaS-grade packaging

Commercial truth

You can sell today as:

- managed pilot
- concierge private beta
- founder-led wholesale AIOS setup
- approval-first operator system

You should not yet sell as:

- polished self-serve SaaS
- benchmark-complete final product
- integration-complete wholesale operating system

Recommended artifact set created in this run

- docs/ares/benchmark/EXTRACTED_SPEC.md
- docs/ares/benchmark/AGENT.md
- docs/ares/benchmark/PLAN.md
- docs/ares/benchmark/SOURCE_OF_TRUTH.md
- docs/ares/benchmark/FEATURE_MATRIX.md
- docs/ares/benchmark/CURRENT_BUILD_GAP_ANALYSIS.md

Next best move

Use SOURCE_OF_TRUTH.md as the canonical contract and build towards benchmark parity module-by-module, starting with compliance, collections depth, WhatsApp execution, and inventory depth.

Current Build Gap Analysis

Current Build vs Benchmark Gap Analysis

Executive read

The current Ares build is **pilot-ready for an approval-first concierge workflow**, but it is **not yet benchmark-equivalent** to the final Hermes Vyapar spec.

It currently behaves like:

- a local operator loop
- a workflow engine for ingestion, radar generation, and approvals
- a good foundation for a managed pilot

It does **not yet** behave like:

- a full compliance-native wholesale operating system
- a multilingual WhatsApp business copilot with production integrations
- a polished self-serve SaaS product

What exists now and maps well

1. Approval-first operator control loop

Evidence:

- `apps/ares/ares/cli.py`
- `apps/ares/ares/autonomy/runner.py`
- `apps/ares/ares/face/mobile_approval.py`
- `apps/ares/ares/execution/actions.py`

Current state:

- `setup`, `validate-inputs`, `morning-run`, `mobile-approvals`, and `mobile-reply` exist.
- `Morning-run` composes ingestion + payment radar + daily brief + approval prompt.
- Execution remains approval-gated and auditable.

Benchmark alignment:

- Strong alignment with the owner-loop philosophy.
- Still much narrower than the benchmark's business-partner scope.

2. Local persistence and deterministic client scaffolding

Evidence:

- `apps/ares/ares/paths.py`

- apps/ares/ares/profiles.py
- apps/ares/ares/data/json_repository.py

Current state:

- per-client local folders under ~/.ares/clients/<client>/
- JSON-backed records for invoices, orders, stock, approvals, memories, workflow runs, action logs

Benchmark alignment:

- Good for pilot operations and audit trail foundations.
- Not enough for hosted multi-tenant SaaS or enterprise-grade resiliency.

3. Basic order, stock, and collections intelligence

Evidence:

- apps/ares/ares/workflows/order_capture.py
- apps/ares/ares/workflows/payment_radar.py
- apps/ares/ares/workflows/stock_radar.py
- apps/ares/ares/workflows/daily_brief.py
- apps/ares/ares/connectors/export_parser.py

Current state:

- regex-based message order extraction
- outstanding invoice parsing from CSV
- stock report parsing from CSV
- low-stock and overdue payment surfacing
- brief generation for the owner

Benchmark alignment:

- Partial alignment with WhatsApp order parsing, ledger visibility, low-stock alerts, and daily briefing.
- Depth, accuracy, and integration levels are far below benchmark targets.

Major benchmark gaps

A. Compliance engine is mostly missing

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-01
- parts of MOD-09

Missing or not yet implemented in product code:

- GST invoice generation
- NIC IRN / QR e-invoice flow
- GSTR-1 draft generation

- ITC 2A/2B reconciliation
- e-way bill automation
- multi-GSTIN logic
- TDS/TCS computation
- composition-scheme guardrails
- GSTN production integration

Grounding:

- The current codebase has CSV parsing for exports, but no implemented compliance engine surface.
- Search coverage in apps/ares/ares shows no real GSTN/NIC integration workflow implementation.

B. Real communication layer is missing

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-07

Current state:

- mobile approval formatting exists
- current message execution defaults to dry-run sender in `execution/actions.py`
- no implemented WhatsApp Business API connector in the Ares app layer
- no voice/IVR stack in apps/ares

Gap:

- no real invoice dispatch over WhatsApp
- no DLT workflow
- no voice-note processing pipeline
- no regional language operational layer beyond profile metadata / Hinglish-oriented text handling

C. Inventory depth is limited

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-04

Current state:

- stock ledger is shallow
- reorder logic is basic threshold math

Missing:

- batch/expiry/FIFO enforcement
- GRN and three-way match
- warehouse depth
- supplier-side debit-note flow
- festive demand planning

D. Distribution/principal intelligence is mostly absent

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-05

Missing:

- beat route management
- principal-specific margin and terms engine
- claims and scheme reconciliation stack
- salesman scorecards
- retailer onboarding with verification/KYC/DigiLocker

E. Financial ops depth is mostly absent

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-06

Current state:

- some payment extraction and reminder drafting

Missing:

- daily cashflow statement
- supplier payable scheduling
- bank statement parsing across Indian formats
- working capital / CCC intelligence

F. Analytics layer is underbuilt

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-08

Current state:

- a basic daily brief exists

Missing:

- principal-wise P&L
- SKU performance analytics
- retailer segmentation
- mandi price integration
- owner-grade financial drill-down

G. Integration layer is mostly placeholder-level

Benchmark modules affected:

- MOD-09

Current state:

- Drive manifest sync exists
- a thin Google Sheets adapter shape exists

Missing:

- real Tally/Busy sync
- real GSTN integration
- UPI/payment gateway webhooks
- logistics APIs
- AA framework
- ONDC node support

H. Product shell / SaaS polish is missing

Outside the benchmark modules but necessary for sellable SaaS:

- no self-serve web product shell in apps/ares
- no auth/signup/billing surface in apps/ares
- no hosted control plane, plan limits, or deployment layer in product scope

Readiness verdict

What Ares is right now

- pilot-capable concierge engine
- operator workflow backend
- approval-safe company-brain foundation

What Ares is not yet

- benchmark-equal Hermes Vyapar
- polished self-serve SaaS
- production integration-complete wholesale AIOS

Recommended next build order

- MOD-01 compliance engine
- MOD-03 collections and ledger depth
- MOD-07 real WhatsApp layer
- MOD-04 inventory depth + GRN/batch/expiry
- MOD-05 principal/beat/claim intelligence
- MOD-08 owner analytics
- MOD-09 external integrations

- web/mobile/dashboard shell
- hosted SaaS infrastructure and billing

Source of Truth Snapshot

Ares Benchmark Source of Truth

Product identity

- Product name: **Ares / Hermes Vyapar**
- Segment: **Indian wholesalers and distributors**
- Product posture: **business partner that runs on software, not generic SaaS**
- Languages: **Hinglish primary + 7 regional languages**
- Interface order: **WhatsApp-first, mobile-second, web-dashboard third, voice as accessibility layer**
- Operating model: **approval-first, audit-heavy, owner-safe, accountant-compatible**

Final polish definition

Ares reaches final polish only when it behaves like a trusted senior employee with perfect memory, zero ego, and strong compliance discipline. The owner should not need to change their workflow to fit the software; the agent should adapt itself to the owner, the accountant, and the sales/distribution realities of Indian wholesale.

Non-negotiable design principles

- GST-native
- WhatsApp-first
- Hinglish-primary
- Tally-compatible
- MSME-calibrated
- Offline-resilient
- Zero-training UX
- Udhaar-aware

Measurable polish KPIs

- GST invoice generation: **<3s**
- ITC match accuracy: **98%+**
- Languages supported: **8+**
- Manual e-way bill effort: **0**
- Udhaar leakage: **■0 target**
- Agent availability: **24/7**
- Order error rate: **<2%**

- Tally sync trigger: **1-tap**

Final polish user test

Small wholesaler test

- Works fully in Hindi/Hinglish with no English dependency
- Orders, ledger queries, and complaints work via WhatsApp
- GST invoices auto-generate and auto-forward
- Payment reminders trigger on due dates automatically
- Runs on low-end Android + poor connectivity conditions

Large distributor test

- Handles 120+ SKUs across 8 principals without spreadsheets
- GSTR-1 and ITC workflows operate on time every month
- Beat-route performance and underperforming retailers are visible
- Claim cycles are tracked and escalated
- Principal-wise margin/P&L is owner-readable

Canonical feature inventory

Note: the PDF footer says "47 Features," but the explicit module tables enumerate 48 named feature rows. This source-of-truth preserves the full enumerated list and treats the PDF footer as a likely counting mismatch.

MOD-01 — GST & Compliance Engine (Critical)

- [P0] Smart GST Invoicing
- [P0] GSTR-1 Auto-Preparation
- [P0] ITC Reconciliation (2A/2B)
- [P0] E-Way Bill Automation
- [P1] Multi-GSTIN Management
- [P1] TDS / TCS Computation
- [P2] Composition Scheme Guard

MOD-02 — Order Intelligence Engine (Core)

- [P0] WhatsApp Order Parsing
- [P0] Credit Limit Enforcement
- [P0] Beat Route Order Collation
- [P1] Scheme & Offer Auto-Apply
- [P1] Return & Damage Management

MOD-03 — Udhaar & Collections Engine (Critical)

- [P0] Party-wise Ledger
- [P0] Aging Analysis & Alerts
- [P0] PDC Cheque Tracker
- [P0] UPI Payment Reconciliation
- [P1] Credit Scoring per Party
- [P1] Collections Dashboard

MOD-04 — Inventory Intelligence (Core)

- [P0] Real-time Stock Ledger
- [P0] Batch & Expiry Tracking
- [P1] Auto-Reorder Intelligence
- [P1] Goods Receipt Note (GRN)
- [P2] Festive Demand Planning

MOD-05 — Distribution Network Intelligence (Core)

- [P0] Beat Route Management
- [P0] Principal / Brand Management
- [P0] Claim & Scheme Reconciliation
- [P1] Salesman Performance Tracking
- [P1] New Party Onboarding

MOD-06 — Financial Operations & Payments (Core)

- [P0] Daily Cash Flow Statement
- [P0] Supplier Payment Scheduling
- [P1] Bank Statement Reconciliation
- [P2] Working Capital Intelligence

MOD-07 — Language & Communication Layer (Critical)

- [P0] Hinglish NLU Engine
- [P0] Regional Language Support
- [P0] WhatsApp Business Integration
- [P1] Automated Communication Workflows
- [P2] Voice Query Interface

MOD-08 — Analytics & Decision Intelligence (Advanced)

- [P0] Principal-wise P&L
- [P1] SKU Performance Intelligence
- [P1] Retailer Segmentation

- [P1] Daily Owner Briefing
- [P2] Mandi Price Integration

MOD-09 — Integration & Interoperability Layer (Advanced)

- [P0] Tally / Busy Sync
- [P0] GSTN API Integration
- [P0] UPI & Payment Gateway
- [P1] Logistics Integration
- [P2] Account Aggregator / AA
- [P2] ONDC Seller Node

Build sequence

Phase 1 — Non-negotiable core (Months 1–3)

- GST invoicing + e-invoice + e-way bill
- Party ledger + PDC tracker + WhatsApp collections
- Basic inventory + batch expiry
- WhatsApp order capture + credit limit enforcement
- Hinglish NLU for top 5 use cases
- Tally sync (one-way push)

Phase 2 — Operational intelligence (Months 4–6)

- GSTR-1 auto-preparation + ITC reconciliation
- Beat route management + salesman tracking
- Principal-wise P&L + scheme reconciliation
- Auto-reorder + GRN + three-way match
- UPI reconciliation + supplier payment scheduling
- Regional language support

Phase 3 — Polish and differentiation (Months 7–9)

- Credit scoring + account aggregator
- Festive demand planning + mandi price integration
- Daily owner briefing + retailer segmentation
- Voice interface
- ONDC seller node + logistics API
- Working capital intelligence + CCC tracking

Absolute done-state gate

- Semi-literate salesman uses it daily without training
- Owner trusts agent summaries without calling accountant
- CA can close books from Tally without re-entry
- Zero GST penalty across 12 months of agent-managed operation
- Every rupee of udhaar is tracked to settlement
- 7 AM owner briefing reliably tells the owner what matters today